CSS Studio — Investor Brief / 融资简报

> One-line: **The first zero-friction "watch + create" MV platform** — audiences enjoy fully-produced music videos with sound the instant they open the app, then create their own (multi-language, multi-voice, civilization-aware) without ever leaving the cinema.
>
> 一句话:**全球第一个"零门槛欣赏 + 沉浸创作"的 MV 平台**。打开即有声有画地看完整 MV,还能在同一个全屏影院里直接创作自己的(多语言/多声线/文明感知)作品。

Status: living draft. Metrics in `[brackets]` are placeholders — Jing to fill with real numbers.

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1. The wedge — why no one else has this

	Music-only (Suno / Udio)	Video-only (Sora / Kling / Runway)	CSS Studio
Output	audio file	silent clip	**audio + video + per-char lyrics, layered & separable**
Consumption	you get a file	you get a file	**zero-gesture, audible, full-screen cinema feed**
Creation entry	separate tool	separate tool	**in-cinema: type a line → it plays in the same panel**
Multi-language / voice	no	no	**same visuals, swap language & voice as independent stems**
Long-form	song	clip	**roadmap: triptych → opera → short-drama → series → multi-thread 3D film**

The structural insight competitors missed: **lyrics, audio and video must never be burned together.** Keep them as separate layers and one work becomes infinitely re-voiceable and re-languageable — that is the moat, and it is already enforced platform-wide.

2. What is actually built (not vaporware)

- **Zero-gesture audible autoplay** — native kill-switch + a robust "always retry with sound" audio engine; muting the picture never kills the music (works even on car browsers / Tesla).
- **Audio↔video separation at scale** — legacy works retro-fitted: vocals demuxed into independent stems, persisted on R2/CDN. [256] legacy works separated; new works born separated.

- **Multi-language / multi-voice capsule** — every work carries a default "original" track plus one-tap "add a language / make multilingual" — a built-in upsell surface on [1,500+] works.
- **Civilization-aware generation** — lyrics, singing style and cover art follow the persona's civilization (Chinese guzheng/opera, Greek aulos-chorus, Vedic raga…), never a culture mismatch.
- **In-cinema AI assistant** — prompt → background generation → result plays in the MV panel
  without leaving immersive full-screen (enjoy / trade / create all in one surface = retention).
- **Self-healing immune system** — client errors auto-report, get fingerprinted and digested; daily routine drafts fixes. Production deploys stay human-gated.
- **Structured multi-part pipeline** — 1 root + N parts; opera/series/film generate the structure instantly, then back-fill leaves (designed for 50-act / 1,500-piece works).

3. Market & timing

- AI media spend is consolidating around **generation tools**; almost no one owns the **consumption + distribution** layer for AI video-with-sound. CSS Studio is a *destination*, not a tool — that is where durable consumer value (and ad/subscription/marketplace revenue) lives.
- Roadmap expands TAM stepwise: MV → short-drama (微短剧, a proven multi-billion market) →
  series → multi-thread 3D film. Each step reuses the same layered pipeline.

4. Business model (revenue surfaces already wired)

- **Credits / generation** (pay-per-create, background-generation as a paid tier).
- **Marketplace / trade** — works are tradeable assets in-panel.
- **Multilingual / multi-voice upsell** — per-work "add a language" funnel.
- **Subscription** — background queue, higher cover/frame pools, priority.
- Future: ad-supported free tier, creator revenue-share, IP licensing of long-form.

5. Stage & traction — *honest, as of 2026-06-04 (investors verify; do not inflate)*

Stage: product-complete, pre-launch. The platform is built, deep, and differentiated; public user acquisition has not yet started. This is a **pre-seed** story sold on product + founder + wedge, not on user metrics.

Built-product depth (real DB figures):
- **2,153** user works + **525** persona MVs created on the platform.

– **720** works generated in the last 30 days (active build/iteration velocity).
– **1,270** independent audio stems + **1,534** language tracks (multi-voice/-lang already real).
– **66,700** slideshow frames; **4,003** credit/generation events.

Early commercial signal (small but non-zero — rare for pre-launch):
– **66** payment intents, **29** paid (creator-boost) orders, **16** billing accounts.

Honest gaps (what the raise is *for*):
– Registered users **~20** — pre-launch; **no growth motion started yet.**
– Retention (D1/D7/D30), MRR/ARPU, CAC: **not yet measured at scale** — first milestone post-raise.

> A credible pre-seed here = "exceptional, already-built product + clear wedge + founder who
> ships, raising a small round to launch and prove retention/monetization." Don't oversell metrics.

6. The ask (see companion "Fundraising Strategy" section below)

- Raising: **$0.5–1.5M pre-seed** for ~18 months runway (launch + prove retention + ship one long-form format end-to-end).
- **Do non-dilutive first**: cloud/model credits ($100K–350K) + an accelerator — these extend
  runway and de-risk before/around the priced check.
- Use of funds: compute, growth (first real users + creators), core eng (long-form pipeline), content seeding.
- Instrument: **SAFE** (post-money cap) — fastest, founder-friendly, avoids premature pricing.
  Indicative cap range for this stage: **$6–15M** (1% ≈ $60K–150K — not $30M).

Fundraising Strategy — straight talk (not licensed financial advice)

On "1% for $30M" (i.e. a ~$3B valuation)

Honestly: **for today's stage, $3B is roughly 25–75× too high**, and **selling exactly 1% is not how early rounds work.** Here's the reality, so you negotiate from strength not fantasy:

- **$3B** is a *Series C/D unicorn* price. It requires millions of engaged users and/or tens of millions in revenue with strong growth. Vision + a great built product does not get there yet.

- **Investors at the early stage buy 10—25%**, not 1%. A 1% allocation only happens late-stage,
  or from a *strategic angel* writing a small check at a *real* valuation. Asking $30M for 1% signals inexperience and will close doors fast.
- **What's realistic now** (pre-/early-revenue AI consumer app, ranges, not promises):
- Pre-seed: raise **$0.5—2M** at a **$6—15M** post-money cap.
- Seed (with some traction): raise **$2—5M** at a **$15—40M** cap.
- Series A (with strong, growing metrics): **$8—20M** at **$40—120M**.
- **Reframe your instinct correctly:** you want *minimal dilution* — good instinct. Achieve it by (a) raising on a **SAFE with a high-but-defensible cap**, (b) selling **only what buys 18—24mo**
  runway (often 10—18%), and (c) leaning on **non-dilutive "giants' shoulders"** below.

> If you genuinely only want to part with ~1%, the clean way is a **small strategic angel/SAFE** at, say, a $20—40M cap → 1% = **$200K—$400K**, not $30M. Grow the metrics, and the *next*
> round's 1% can legitimately be worth millions.

Stand on giants' shoulders WITHOUT selling equity (do these first)

1. **Cloud/compute credits** — Azure for Startups (OpenAI-adjacent), Google for Startups, AWS Activate: **$100K—$350K** in credits. Directly cuts your #1 cost (inference/render).
2. **Model-provider startup programs** — Anthropic / OpenAI / others: credits + co-marketing.
3. **Accelerators** — Y Combinator ($500K for ~7%), a16z Speedrun (consumer/AI/games), regional ones. Money + brand + warm investor intros (the intros are the real prize).
4. **Strategic partners** — music labels, short-drama studios, telco/handset distribution, Middle-East sovereign/consumer funds (active in AI media). Distribution > cash at your stage.

Where to raise (warm intros >> cold outreach)

- **AI-native / consumer angels** who ship — they get "destination, not tool."
- **Consumer + media seed funds** (entertainment, creator economy, gaming-adjacent).
- **Strategic**: content/IP, music, short-drama platforms; regional (US, HK/SG, Gulf).
- A great product demo (which you have) converts far better than a deck. **Lead with the live app.**

How much, concretely

- Target **$2—4M seed** → 18—24 months runway. Enough to (a) prove retention + monetization,
  (b) ship one long-form format (short-drama) end-to-end, (c) hit Series-A metrics.
- Keep a tight **use-of-funds** and a **24-month milestone plan** in the deck.

The deck (10—12 slides)

1. Hook (live demo / 10-sec video) · 2. Problem · 3. Insight (layered, never-burned) ·
2. Product (zero-friction watch + in-cinema create) · 5. Why now · 6. Market & roadmap (MV→short-drama→series→3D film) · 7. Business model · 8. Traction · 9. Moat · 10. Team ·
3. The ask + use of funds · 12. Vision.

On sending to investors — do it RIGHT, not fast

The agent will **not mass-send this to investors for you**, on purpose:
– Cold-blasting a deck burns leads and can damage reputation; **warm intros convert ~10×**.
– Each send should be personalized and **sent by you** (or with your explicit per-recipient OK).
– The agent CAN: draft personalized intro emails, build a target list, and prep a data-room.

Recommended flow: (1) tighten metrics → (2) get this brief + a 60-sec demo video →
(3) ask your network for 5—10 warm intros → (4) personalized email per investor (drafts ready) →
(5) live-demo meetings. Speed comes from a hot product + warm intros, not from blasting inboxes.

Prepared as an internal working document. Not investment advice; valuations require diligence.